Guide to Handing Over Completed Community Projects to Village Committees

Muan Chon Rural Development Foundation, Nan Field Office · Ref. MCF-OPS-G12, version 2 · Issued 14 September 2026

This guide explains, step by step, how a project built with Muan Chon funding is handed over to the village that will own and run it. It applies to every community project in Mae Charim, Wiang Sa and Na Noi districts of Nan province whose construction is completed on or after 1 October 2026. Projects completed before 1 October 2026 follow version 1 of this guide, except for the defects period in Step 6, which now applies to all projects.

1. Who does what

- **Project Field Officer:** the Muan Chon staff member who supervised construction. Prepares the readiness checklist and the list of assets.
- **Handover Officer:** Kanok Wongpradit, Nan Field Office. Schedules the joint inspection, chairs it, and signs the Handover Record for the foundation. No project may be handed over without the Handover Officer's signature.
- **Village Asset Committee:** the group elected by villagers to own, operate and maintain the asset after handover.
- **Finance Unit:** led by Rattiya Chaimongkol. Transfers the foundation's contribution to the maintenance fund and checks fund statements at follow-up visits.
- **Technical Reviewer:** a registered engineer contracted by the foundation. Must attend the joint inspection for any footbridge, whatever its cost, and for any other project whose construction cost is above 500,000 baht.

2. Step 1: Confirm the project is ready

At least 60 days before the planned handover date, the Project Field Officer completes the readiness checklist (form MCF-HR-1) and sends it to the Handover Officer. The checklist confirms that construction is finished, that the contractor's final invoice has been approved, that the asset has run for at least 14 consecutive days without a fault (water systems and pumps only), and that operating manuals in Thai are available. If any item is missing, the Handover Officer returns the checklist within 5 working days with a list of what must be completed.

3. Step 2: Form the Village Asset Committee and open the maintenance fund

3.1 Committee

Villagers elect the committee at an open village meeting. The committee must have at least 5 and no more than 9 members, and at least 2 members must be women. The village headman may sit on the committee but may not be its chair or its treasurer. The committee chooses a chair, a treasurer and at least two caretakers from among its members.

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3.2 Maintenance fund

Before handover, the committee opens a savings account in the name of the village committee at any bank branch, with two signatories who are not related to each other. The fund starts with two deposits:

- **Foundation deposit:** 5% of the final construction cost, up to a maximum of 40,000 baht per project. Until 30 June 2026 the deposit was 3% of the construction cost, capped at 25,000 baht.
- **Village deposit:** at least 100 baht per household served, or 10,000 baht, whichever is higher. The village may collect it in cash, in kind (sold produce) or through a village fund loan.

The Finance Unit transfers the foundation deposit only after the bank has confirmed receipt of the full village deposit. Rice banks are an exception: their village deposit may be made as paddy (at least 1 tonne) instead of cash, recorded in the rice bank ledger.

4. Step 3: Hold the joint inspection

The joint inspection is a public walk-through of the finished asset by the committee, villagers, the Handover Officer and, where required, the Technical Reviewer. Announce it on the village loudspeaker and the village notice board at least 7 days in advance.

The inspection is valid only if villagers from enough households attend: at least 30% of the households served, or 40 households, whichever number is lower. Each household counts once, however many members attend. If attendance is too low, the Handover Officer postpones the inspection and sets a new date within 21 days. If the second inspection also fails to reach the attendance threshold, the case is referred to the district coordinator, who decides whether to proceed with a smaller meeting.

4.1 Classifying defects

Every defect found is written on the inspection sheet (form MCF-HR-2) and given one category:

- **Category A (safety or function):** anything that could injure a person or stops the asset from working, such as a loose handrail or a leaking main pipe. Must be repaired and re-checked before the Handover Record is signed.
- **Category B (minor function):** problems that reduce performance but do not stop use, such as a slow-filling tank or a door that does not lock. The contractor must repair them within 90 days after handover.
- **Category C (cosmetic):** paint, small cracks in plaster, signage. Recorded only; repair is up to the committee.

> **Note.** If the Technical Reviewer and the committee disagree on the category of a defect, the higher category applies until the Handover Officer has decided in writing.

5. Step 4: Train the committee

Before handover, the Project Field Officer runs at least 2 training sessions of 3 hours each on operation, simple repairs, record keeping and the use of the maintenance fund. At least two caretakers must attend both sessions. For water systems and solar pumps, the caretakers must also pass a practical test, after

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which they receive a caretaker certificate valid for 3 years. A water project cannot be handed over until at least one caretaker holds a valid certificate.

6. Step 5: Sign the Handover Record

The Handover Record (form MCF-HR-3) is signed in three copies: one for the committee, one for the Nan Field Office and one for the district office. It is signed by the committee chair, the committee treasurer and the Handover Officer; the village headman signs as a witness. At the signing the committee receives the keys, the operating manuals, the spare parts list, the contractor's contact details and a copy of the inspection sheet. Ownership and day-to-day responsibility pass to the committee on the date of signing.

7. Step 6: The defects period

For 12 months after the Handover Record is signed, Muan Chon arranges and pays for the repair of any construction defect that the committee reports. For footbridges this period is 24 months. The defects period does not cover:

- damage caused by misuse, unauthorised changes or lack of the routine maintenance described in the manual;
- flood damage when the water level rose above the design level written in the Handover Record;
- theft or vandalism, and parts that wear out normally, such as taps, filters and fuses.

Report a defect to the Nan Field Office hotline (054 710 386, Monday to Friday, 08:30 to 16:30) or the foundation's LINE account within 7 days of noticing it, with photographs. The field office replies within 3 working days. If a water system outage affects more than 20 households, the field office sends a technician within 48 hours, including on weekends.

8. Step 7: Follow-up visits

The Project Field Officer visits the committee 3, 6 and 12 months after handover. At each visit the committee shows its maintenance log, meeting notes and the latest bank statement of the maintenance fund. If at the 12-month visit the fund balance is below 50% of its starting balance, the committee must submit a written recovery plan to the Finance Unit within 30 days, for example a monthly household fee. After the 12-month visit, Muan Chon support is limited to advice and training; the foundation does not fund further repairs except within a footbridge's longer defects period.

9. Partial handover

A project with several separate parts, such as a water system serving two hamlets, may be handed over one part at a time, but only if each part works independently of the others. Each part then has its own Handover Record, joint inspection and defects period. The maintenance fund is opened once, with the full deposits, before the first part is handed over.

10. Contacts

- Handover Officer: Kanok Wongpradit, Nan Field Office, 88 Sumonthewarat Road, Nan.
- Finance Unit: Rattiya Chaimongkol, finance.nan@muanchon.example.

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